PARTICIPANT REFERENCE GUIDE

Microsoft 365 Copilot for Business Capability Guide

What Copilot can do, where it fits, who can use it, and where to learn more, in Microsoft's own words and links.

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Individual Productivity	Repeatable Workflow	Shared Capability	Business Workflow	Emerging & Frontier

For: business users, marketers, leaders and practitioners using a MAICON-style Microsoft 365 Copilot workshop, during the session and afterward.

Last verified: October 11, 2026. Copilot changes fast, so check the linked Microsoft page before you rely on a detail.

Inside: 29 capability cards in five categories, a one-page quick finder, a map of where Skills show up, a short Emerging & Frontier preview, and the Microsoft sources to keep learning.

Independent workshop resource. Not produced, reviewed or endorsed by Microsoft. Capability descriptions are plain-language paraphrases of Microsoft documentation. The five categories are the workshop's navigation framework, not Microsoft's taxonomy. Microsoft, Microsoft 365, Copilot and related names are trademarks of the Microsoft group of companies.

How to use this guide

Every capability has the same card, so you can answer four questions in seconds.

1. What is it?	Microsoft description
2. When would I use it?	Best for (our interpretation, clearly labeled as workshop guidance, not Microsoft's words)
3. Do I have access?	Availability and License / access
4. Where can I learn more?	Learn more (Microsoft Support, Learn, product pages, blog) and Last verified

How to read the Availability label

We label a capability Generally Available when Microsoft's documentation presents it as available without a preview or Frontier label, or states general availability directly. When a piece is still rolling out or in preview, the note beside the label says so.

Generally Available	Microsoft documents it as available to eligible customers.
Rolling Out	Releasing in stages. You may not see it yet, and a colleague might.
Preview	Early version that can change. Not meant for production use.
Frontier	Early access through Microsoft's opt-in Frontier program. Your organization must opt in.
Announced	Microsoft has announced it but it is not yet available.
Not Specified	Microsoft's page does not state the status.

The five categories

Use these to find your way around. Microsoft does not organize its products this way.

Individual Productivity	Capabilities focused on one person improving their own work.
Repeatable Workflow	Capabilities that help you set up repeatable ways of working.
Shared Capability	Capabilities that let you create something reusable for other people.
Business Workflow	Capabilities that extend beyond personal use into team and business processes.
Emerging & Frontier	A short look at where Microsoft is heading next.

Read this first: names and licenses

Names you will see in Microsoft's materials

Microsoft renamed several things recently. This guide uses the name shown on each linked Microsoft page.

Name	What changed	Source
Microsoft Copilot app	The Microsoft 365 Copilot app is now called the Microsoft Copilot app, and the web address is copilot.cloud.microsoft.	Microsoft Support
Microsoft Copilot Chat	Learn and Support pages now say Microsoft Copilot Chat. You may still see Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat in older material.	Microsoft Learn
Agents becoming Plugins	The Agents button is being replaced by a Plugins button from late October to late November 2026. Agents still exist as one kind of plugin.	Message Center MC1484008
Tools instead of actions	Copilot Studio documentation now says tools for what agents can do. Actions still appears in some screens and flows.	Microsoft Learn
AI at Work Roadmap	The Microsoft 365 Roadmap is now called the Microsoft AI at Work Roadmap.	Microsoft Learn

Which Copilot do you have?

Microsoft Learn describes three license experiences. Look for the in-product label (for example, Microsoft 365 Copilot (Basic) or (Premium)) in Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneNote and the Copilot app.

Copilot Chat (Basic)	Included with eligible Microsoft 365 licenses. Chat with web data. No Copilot in Word, Excel, PowerPoint or OneNote. Agents that use web data; work-data agents are pay-as-you-go.
Microsoft 365 Copilot (Basic)	No add-on license. Standard access to Copilot in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and OneNote. Chat with web data. Work-data agents are pay-as-you-go.
Microsoft 365 Copilot (Premium)	Has the Microsoft 365 Copilot add-on license. Priority access to the full experience in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and OneNote. Chat with web and work data (Microsoft Graph and Work IQ). Includes agents that use web and work data. Cowork through usage-based billing.

Source: Microsoft Learn, What is Microsoft Copilot?

Everyday AI and advanced AI

Microsoft now separates two kinds of work. The per-user Copilot subscription license (USL) covers everyday AI such as Copilot Chat and Copilot in Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook and Teams. Advanced AI, meaning Cowork, Code, Autopilot, new agentic experiences in SharePoint and the newest frontier models, uses usage-based billing (UBB) with Copilot Credits on top of the license. For enterprise tenants these usage-based features stay off until an admin creates a spending policy in the Microsoft 365 admin center, so if a feature is missing, ask your admin about billing before assuming it is unavailable.

Sources: Microsoft Learn, USL and UBB | Microsoft Copilot pricing

Quick finder

Every capability in this guide on one page. Details, links and verification dates are on each card.

Capability	Category	Availability	Access (short)
Microsoft Copilot Chat	Individual Productivity	GA	Included with eligible M365 licenses; work data needs the Copilot add-on
Copilot in Word	Individual Productivity	GA	Eligible M365 subscription or Copilot license
Copilot in Excel	Individual Productivity	GA	Eligible M365 subscription or Copilot license
Copilot in PowerPoint	Individual Productivity	GA (some options Frontier)	Eligible M365 subscription or Copilot license
Copilot in Outlook	Individual Productivity	GA	Basic chat without add-on; richer data with Copilot add-on
Copilot in Teams (meetings and recap)	Individual Productivity	GA	Copilot license (recap also with Teams Premium)
Copilot in OneNote	Individual Productivity	GA (web and Teams rolling out)	Copilot (Work) license; eligible subscription on Windows
Copilot in SharePoint	Individual Productivity	Rolling Out (GA began Sept 30, 2026)	Copilot license; advanced work needs usage-based billing
Copilot Pages	Individual Productivity	GA	SharePoint or OneDrive plan; Copilot license not required
Researcher	Individual Productivity	GA	Copilot add-on license
Analyst	Individual Productivity	GA	Copilot license; admin must enable
Word, Excel, and PowerPoint Agents	Individual Productivity	GA	Paid Copilot license; admin must allow Anthropic models
Microsoft Copilot Cowork	Individual Productivity	GA (App skill is Frontier)	Copilot license plus usage-based billing
Copilot Notebooks	Repeatable Workflow	GA (newest features Frontier)	Copilot or Copilot Chat license plus SharePoint or OneDrive plan
Scheduled prompts	Repeatable Workflow	GA	Copilot license; connected experiences on
Scheduled and event-driven tasks in Cowork	Repeatable Workflow	GA	Copilot license plus usage-based billing
Skills in Copilot in PowerPoint	Repeatable Workflow	GA	Copilot in PowerPoint access; custom skills stored in OneDrive
Skills in Copilot in Excel	Repeatable Workflow	GA (English only)	Copilot in Excel access; English display language
Skills in Copilot Chat and Cowork	Repeatable Workflow	Rolling Out (from Oct 2026)	Not specified; admin can deploy or block
Agents (built by Microsoft, your organization, or you)	Shared Capability	GA (UI label changing to Plugins)	Varies by agent; admin approval controls the list
Agent Builder	Shared Capability	GA (skills are preview)	Depends on tenant licenses; admin can disable
Agents in SharePoint	Shared Capability	GA (follows Copilot in SharePoint)	Copilot license or pay-as-you-go; site edit permission to create
Knowledge sources and Copilot connectors	Shared Capability	GA	Copilot license; admin must enable each connector
Brand kit and Brand skills	Shared Capability	GA (desktop rolling out)	Brand kit shared access plus Copilot in PowerPoint
Microsoft Copilot Studio	Business Workflow	GA (apps are preview)	Copilot license for internal agents; standalone plan for external
Tools and actions for agents	Business Workflow	GA	Copilot Studio maker access
Connectors in Copilot Studio	Business Workflow	GA (as knowledge: preview)	Standard in all plans; premium in select plans
Agent flows	Business Workflow	GA	Copilot Studio maker access; capacity-based
Workflows in Copilot Studio	Business Workflow	GA (some authoring labeled preview)	Copilot Studio maker access; Copilot Credits

1 Individual Productivity

Capabilities focused on one person improving their own work.

Start here. These capabilities help one person get their own work done faster, inside the apps and the Copilot app they already use.

Microsoft Copilot Chat

You may also see: Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	A secure AI chat for work. Ask questions, draft content, summarize and catch up. Signed in with a work account, it can also use your organization's data and the web, and a Work IQ control lets you turn work-data grounding on or off. The same app also hosts Cowork.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	Copilot Chat (Basic) is included with eligible Microsoft 365 licenses and works with web data. Chat that reasons over your work data (Microsoft Graph and Work IQ) is part of the Microsoft 365 Copilot (Premium) add-on license experience.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Your daily starting point: quick questions, first drafts, meeting and email catch-up, and a place to ask "what can Copilot do here?"*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-microsoft-365-copilot-chat **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/overview

Copilot in Word

Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	Helps you draft from a prompt, outline or referenced file, rewrite selected text, and summarize or ask questions about a document. Edits happen in your original file, and Copilot can draw on your files, emails and meetings when they are available.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	Requires an eligible Microsoft 365 subscription and/or a Microsoft Copilot license. Microsoft Learn describes standard access with Microsoft 365 Copilot (Basic) and priority access with the Microsoft 365 Copilot add-on. Copilot Chat (Basic) alone does not include Copilot in Word.
Best for (our interpretation)	*First drafts, tone and length changes, and summarizing long documents before a meeting.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/word/welcome-to-copilot-in-word

Copilot in Excel
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	Builds and edits workbooks with Excel's own tools: tables, charts, PivotTables and formulas. It opens in edit mode by default, with plan mode (map out the work first) and chat mode (answers stay in the chat). It can also search the web with citations, import data from other workbooks, and run custom skills.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	Requires an eligible Microsoft 365 subscription and/or a Microsoft Copilot license; Microsoft notes it may be hidden by your subscription or organization settings. Skills in Excel are English-only.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Cleaning data, writing formulas, building a first dashboard, and asking "what stands out in this data?"*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/get-started-with-copilot-in-excel

Copilot in PowerPoint
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	Creates presentations from a prompt or a Word document, edits slides, and applies your organization's template and Brand kit so decks look on-brand. Skills add repeatable, multi-step workflows (see Repeatable Workflow).
Availability	**Generally Available** Some options for presentation length, tone and style are rolling out to Frontier first.
License / access	Requires an eligible Microsoft 365 subscription and/or a Microsoft Copilot license. Brand kit use depends on your brand manager setting one up.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Turning a brief or outline into a draft deck that starts on-template, then refining slide by slide.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/powerpoint/copilot/create-a-new-presentation-with-copilot-in-powerpoint **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/powerpoint/copilot/keep-your-presentation-on-brand-with-copilot

Copilot in Outlook
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	A chat pane inside Outlook that works with your inbox, calendar and meetings. Ask it to summarize email threads, find your next meeting, schedule time, flag messages or set an automatic reply.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	Works with an Entra work or school account. Without a Copilot add-on you can ask about your inbox, calendar and meetings and take actions in Outlook. With the add-on, chat can also use your chats and wider enterprise data.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Inbox triage, thread summaries, and drafting replies with context from your calendar.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/outlook/copilot-outlook/chat-with-copilot-in-outlook

Copilot in Teams (meetings and recap)
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	Summarizes key discussion points during or after a meeting, suggests action items, and answers questions about what was said. The meeting organizer controls whether Copilot is allowed during and after, only during, or off. Transcription is needed to use Copilot after the meeting.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	A Microsoft Copilot license is needed to use Copilot in meetings. Intelligent recap needs a Teams Premium or Microsoft Copilot license, and audio recap needs a Copilot license. Copilot does not work in meetings hosted outside your organization.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Catching up on a meeting you missed, or pulling decisions and action items right after one.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/teams/copilot/catch-up-on-meetings-with-microsoft-365-copilot-in-teams **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoftteams/intelligent-recap-calls-meetings

Copilot in OneNote
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	Summarizes notes, builds task lists, rewrites for clarity and creates new content such as agendas and outlines. A Take notes with Copilot option pulls relevant content from Microsoft 365 documents, messages and emails onto the page.
Availability	**Generally Available** Windows, Mac and iPad are available; web and Teams are rolling out.
License / access	Microsoft Copilot (Work) license in OneNote for Microsoft 365 on Windows, Mac, iPad and the web. An eligible Microsoft 365 subscription also works in OneNote for Windows. Copilot is not available if Windows Information Protection is on.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Turning rough notes into a summary or action list, and drafting meeting agendas.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/onenote/welcome-to-copilot-in-onenote **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/onenote/take-notes-with-copilot-in-onenote

Copilot in SharePoint
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	Brings agentic help into SharePoint so teams can ask questions about site content, run workflows, and create sites, pages, interactive reports and Office files from SharePoint content using natural language.
Availability	**Rolling Out** Public preview ended; general availability began rolling out September 30, 2026, so it may not yet be in your tenant.
License / access	Requires a Microsoft 365 Copilot license. Everyday capabilities are included with it. Advanced work uses Copilot Credits through usage-based billing that your admin must enable.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Asking questions across a team site or library, and drafting pages and reports from content you already store.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/sharepoint/copilot-in-sharepoint-get-started

Copilot Pages
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	A persistent, editable page that sits beside Copilot Chat. Turn a good chat response into content you can edit, keep refining with Copilot, and share so colleagues can co-create. Pages can include interactive charts and dashboards, and can be converted to Word or PowerPoint.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	With a work or school account, available to people who have SharePoint or OneDrive storage, including those without a Microsoft 365 Copilot license. Admins can turn creation off with Cloud Policy.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Project briefs, vendor comparisons, meeting notes and draft communications that evolve and need team input.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-microsoft-365-copilot-pages **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/how-microsoft-365-copilot-pages-works

Researcher
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	A reasoning agent for complex, multistep research. It takes longer than standard chat and returns a structured, source-cited report built from the web and, at work, from your files, emails, meetings and chats.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	Available to Microsoft 365 business and enterprise users with a Microsoft 365 Copilot add-on license (and to Microsoft 365 Premium and Pro subscribers). Find it under Agents in the Microsoft Copilot app; admins can control availability.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Competitive scans, customer or account briefings, and any task where you want citations and a shareable report rather than a quick answer.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-researcher-in-microsoft-365-copilot **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/researcher-agent

Analyst
Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	An agent that acts like a data analyst. Attach spreadsheets, CSVs or other files, ask a plain-language question, and get an easy-to-read report with statistics, trends, outliers, charts and tables.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	Part of the Microsoft Copilot experience for licensed users. Find it under Agents. Microsoft notes that if you do not see it, your administrator may not have enabled it.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Comparing performance across regions or campaigns and finding top performers without building formulas yourself.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-analyst-in-microsoft-365-copilot **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/modules/analyze-visualize-data-copilot/

Word, Excel, and PowerPoint Agents

Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	Agents inside the Microsoft Copilot app that create Word, Excel and PowerPoint files from a chat conversation. They appear in the Tools menu and under All Agents.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	Microsoft Learn calls these premium capabilities for users with a paid Microsoft 365 Copilot license. They use Anthropic models only, so an admin must enable Anthropic models for them to appear.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Creating a first-draft document, workbook or deck from a prompt, then finishing it in the Office app.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/wordexcelppt-agents

Microsoft Copilot Cowork

Category: Individual Productivity

Microsoft description	Lets you hand off longer, multistep work. Describe the outcome, such as a meeting prep, inbox triage or a briefing, and Cowork plans and carries it out across your apps and files, pausing for your approval before sensitive actions like sending email.
Availability	**Generally Available** Generally available for work or school accounts. The App skill inside Cowork needs the Frontier program.
License / access	Requires an active Microsoft 365 Copilot license, Cowork turned on in your environment, and usage-based billing (Copilot Credits) enabled by your admin. Works in the browser, Outlook, Teams, the desktop app and the mobile app.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Delegating work you would normally spend an hour on, where you want to review a finished result instead of chatting step by step.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/cowork/get-started **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/cowork/use-cowork **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-cowork

2 Repeatable Workflow

Capabilities that help you set up repeatable ways of working.

These capabilities help you stop re-explaining the same task. Set up a place, a schedule or a saved set of instructions once, then reuse it. Skills live here because they are reusable instructions, and they appear directly in apps like PowerPoint and Excel, not only in agents.

Copilot Notebooks

Category: Repeatable Workflow

Microsoft description	An AI-powered workspace for a project or topic. Add Word, PowerPoint and Excel files, Copilot Pages, chats, meeting notes and links as references, and Copilot answers using only that curated content. You can set instructions for tone or format, listen to audio overviews, and share a notebook with your team.
Availability	**Generally Available** Newer features, such as creating notebooks with Copilot and editing Office files inside Notebooks, are coming to Frontier first.
License / access	Available to Microsoft Copilot and Copilot Chat licensed users. Work or school accounts must have a SharePoint or OneDrive license (service plan) to create notebooks. Admins can control creation with Cloud Policy.
Best for (our interpretation)	*A repeatable home for an ongoing project, campaign or customer, so every question is grounded in the same set of sources.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-microsoft-365-copilot-notebooks **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/how-microsoft-365-copilot-notebooks-works **Blog:** https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/blog/microsoft-copilot-blog/whats-new-in-notebooks--october-2026/4559105

Scheduled prompts

Category: Repeatable Workflow

Microsoft description	Save a prompt that works and have Copilot run it automatically on a schedule. You choose when and how often, and can get an email when the response is ready. Responses appear in your Chats list.
Availability	**Generally Available** Microsoft Support and Learn document the feature without a preview label.
License / access	A Microsoft Copilot license is required. Available in Copilot Chat, Microsoft Copilot in Teams, and Outlook on the web and desktop. You can create up to 10. It is on by default unless you or your admin turned off connected experiences.
Best for (our interpretation)	*A weekly follow-up sweep, a morning meeting prep, or an end-of-day summary of decisions and action items.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/schedule-your-most-used-copilot-prompts **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/scheduled-prompts

Scheduled and event-driven tasks in Cowork

Category: Repeatable Workflow

Microsoft description	Cowork can run prompts on a schedule and supports event-driven tasks. The Automations area on the Cowork home page lets you view, edit, reschedule and clean up your scheduled tasks.
Availability	**Generally Available** Follows Cowork availability.
License / access	Same as Cowork: an active Microsoft 365 Copilot license, Cowork enabled, and usage-based billing (Copilot Credits) enabled by your admin.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Recurring work that needs more than a summary, such as a weekly brief that gathers material and drafts a deliverable.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/cowork/use-cowork **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/cowork/get-started

Skills in Copilot in PowerPoint

Category: Repeatable Workflow

Microsoft description	A skill is a reusable, instruction-based capability. In PowerPoint you choose skills from the Copilot pane, call one with an @mention, turn them on or off under Manage skills, or add your own custom skills. Microsoft provides built-in skills such as reviewing a presentation or visualizing a slide.
Availability	**Generally Available** Brand kit and Skills in Copilot in PowerPoint were announced as available on September 14, 2026.
License / access	Part of Copilot in PowerPoint, so the same access applies. Custom skills are saved in a Skills folder in your OneDrive and uploaded skills are for your personal use.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Turning a prompt you keep rewriting, like a deck review checklist, into one reusable step.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/powerpoint/copilot/copilot-in-powerpoint-skills **Blog:** https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/category/microsoft-copilot/blog/microsoft-copilot-blog

Skills in Copilot in Excel

Category: Repeatable Workflow

Microsoft description	Skills give Copilot in Excel the instructions to complete repeatable tasks. Choose them from the menu, call one with an @mention, manage them in settings, or add custom skills. Microsoft manages three built-in skills: brandkit, chart-design and theme-design.
Availability	**Generally Available** Skills in Excel are supported only in English; set your Office display language to English.
License / access	Part of Copilot in Excel, so the same access applies. Custom skills live in a Skills folder in your OneDrive, one folder per skill, each with a SKILL.md file.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Applying the same chart and formatting standards across every report you produce.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-skills **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-built-in-skills

Skills in Copilot Chat and Cowork Category: Repeatable Workflow	
Microsoft description	Skills for Copilot Chat let you customize it with task-specific instructions and optional supporting files. Copilot uses a skill automatically when a request fits, or you pick one from the Agents and Skills area. You can create, upload and share skills, and skills created in Chat can also be used in Cowork.
Availability	**Rolling Out** Microsoft Message Center says rollout begins in October 2026, with Information Barriers support in November.
License / access	Not specified beyond Copilot Chat. Admins can deploy, install or block skills, and plugins that contain skills, from the Microsoft 365 admin center.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Capturing a way of working, like a campaign brief format, so it can be reused without re-explaining it.*
Learn more	**Message Center:** https://mc.merill.net/message/MC1493223 **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-microsoft-365-copilot-chat

Skills across Microsoft 365 Copilot: one idea, several places

A skill is a reusable, instruction-based capability. Microsoft documents skills inside apps such as PowerPoint and Excel as well as for agents, so skills are their own capability, not just an agent feature. Quick map:

Where	Microsoft's term	Status	Source
Copilot in PowerPoint	Custom skills; Choose skills; Manage skills	Generally Available	Support
Brand kit (PowerPoint)	Brand skill	Generally Available (desktop rolling out)	Support
Copilot in Excel	Skills; brandkit, chart-design, theme-design	Generally Available (English only)	Support
Copilot Chat and Cowork	Skills; Agents and Skills	Rolling Out (from October 2026)	Message Center
Agent Builder	Skills in Agent Builder	Preview (Frontier)	Learn
Copilot Studio agents	Skills (GitHub Copilot harness)	Generally Available	Learn
Plugins	Skills packaged with connectors, agents, MCP servers	Rolling Out	Learn

3 Shared Capability

Capabilities that let you create something reusable for other people.

These capabilities let you build something once and let other people use it: agents, shared knowledge, and shared brand standards.

Agents (built by Microsoft, your organization, or you)

Category: Shared Capability

Microsoft description	Agents are custom versions of Copilot that combine instructions, knowledge and skills for a specific task. Microsoft-built agents include Researcher, Analyst and Visual Creator. Your organization can publish more to the Agent Store. Before people can use an agent, it goes through a submission and approval process, and admins control what is available.
Availability	**Generally Available** Microsoft is replacing the Agents button with a Plugins button in the app between late October and late November 2026. Agents are not going away.
License / access	Copilot Chat users can use agents available at no extra cost from the Agent Store once admins enable them. Agents that use your organization's data are billed on metered consumption for Copilot Chat users, and are included in the Microsoft 365 Copilot (Premium) experience.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Finding an agent that already does the job before building one, and sharing the good ones with your team.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/agents-built-by-microsoft **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/agent-essentials/m365-agents-admin-guide **Message Center:** https://mc.merill.net/message/MC1484008

Agent Builder

Category: Shared Capability

Microsoft description	A no-code way to build declarative agents for Microsoft 365 Copilot by describing what you want, picking a template, or configuring manually. You can add instructions, knowledge sources such as SharePoint content and Copilot connectors, test the agent, then use or share it. It does not support actions that call external services; for that, copy the agent to Copilot Studio.
Availability	**Generally Available** Adding skills in Agent Builder is in preview for Frontier organizations (see Emerging & Frontier).
License / access	Depends on the licenses assigned in your tenant. Microsoft Learn points to its agent capabilities and licensing models article. Admins can turn Agent Builder off. Not available on mobile.
Best for (our interpretation)	*A coaching, onboarding or Q&A agent for you or a small team, grounded in a SharePoint folder.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/build-your-own-agent-with-microsoft-365-copilot **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/extensibility/agent-builder **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/extensibility/copilot-studio-experience

Agents in SharePoint
Category: Shared Capability

Microsoft description	Scoped AI assistants that answer questions from the sites, pages and files you point them to. Every site has a ready-made Copilot in SharePoint agent. With edit permission you can create your own from a library, list or selected files, set its sources, behavior and starter prompts, and share a link. Custom agents are saved as .agent files on the site.
Availability	**Generally Available** Follows Copilot in SharePoint, which began general availability rollout on September 30, 2026.
License / access	To interact with or create agents you need a Microsoft Copilot license, or your organization needs pay-as-you-go billing enabled for agents in SharePoint. Creating also requires edit permission on the site. Only custom-built agents can be shared.
Best for (our interpretation)	*A team Q&A agent for a policy library, product site or onboarding folder.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/sharepoint/copilot-in-sharepoint/get-started-with-agents-in-sharepoint **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/sharepoint/copilot-in-sharepoint/create-an-agent-in-sharepoint

Knowledge sources and Copilot connectors
Category: Shared Capability

Microsoft description	Knowledge sources are the content an agent draws on, such as SharePoint sites and files. Copilot connectors bring content from outside Microsoft 365, like knowledge bases, ticketing systems or CRM, into Copilot and search. Synced connectors index data into Microsoft Graph. Federated connectors fetch it live. Not the same thing as Copilot Studio connectors in the Business Workflow section.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	You need a Microsoft Copilot license to see connector content. Your admin enables connectors, and you only see content you already have access to.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Letting Copilot and your agents answer from systems of record, not just files, while respecting permissions.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/understand-copilot-connectors **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/connectors/overview

Brand kit and Brand skills
Category: Shared Capability

Microsoft description	Brand managers can build an official Brand kit in the Microsoft Copilot app and upload brand skills (a .md or .zip file) so anyone with shared access to the Brand kit can use them in Copilot in PowerPoint. The Brand kit supplies look and voice, while skills supply the steps for building a deck. Excel also has a Microsoft-managed brandkit skill.
Availability	**Generally Available** Web and Mac rolled out first. Desktop PowerPoint is listed for October 2026.
License / access	Brand managers need own or edit access to a Brand kit. Users need Copilot in PowerPoint and shared access to the Brand kit. Microsoft recommends reviewing skills for security, privacy, accessibility, legal and brand before publishing.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Marketing and brand teams who want every deck to follow the same standards, without policing each one.*
Learn more	**Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/powerpoint/copilot/brand-skill-support-copilot-powerpoint **Support:** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/powerpoint/copilot/keep-your-presentation-on-brand-with-copilot

4 Business Workflow

Capabilities that extend beyond personal use into team and business processes.

These capabilities go beyond personal use and are aimed at makers building solutions for teams or business processes. They usually involve Copilot Studio.

Microsoft Copilot Studio

Category: Business Workflow

Microsoft description	A low-code studio for building and managing AI agents and workflows, connecting them to your data and systems, and publishing them to places people already work such as Teams and Microsoft Copilot. It also has apps in public preview. Everything runs on a harness: the GitHub Copilot harness for reasoning-heavy work, or the standard harness for rule-based agents and agent flows.
Availability	**Generally Available** The GitHub Copilot harness became generally available August 3, 2026. Apps in Copilot Studio are in public preview.
License / access	Microsoft 365 Copilot includes agent-building capabilities for use inside your organization. Publishing to outside channels needs a standalone Copilot Studio plan. Agents and workflows on the GitHub Copilot harness use Copilot Credits.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Teams and makers who need an agent or workflow shared with a whole department, connected to business systems, or with governance and testing.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/fundamentals-what-is-copilot-studio **Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/harnesses-overview **Licensing:** https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/pricing/copilot-studio

Tools and actions for agents

Category: Business Workflow

Microsoft description	Tools are how an agent does something instead of only answering. Copilot Studio documentation now says tools, and groups them as AI prompts, Model Context Protocol (MCP) integrations, and a computer use tool for desktop processes. You may still see the word actions in product screens and older material.
Availability	**Generally Available**
License / access	Follows your Copilot Studio licensing and the harness you build on.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Making an agent look up live data, call a system, or follow a structured output format.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/guidance/agent-tools

Connectors in Copilot Studio
Category: Business Workflow

Microsoft description	Power Platform connectors link agents to other apps and services, both inside and outside Microsoft. Prebuilt connectors cover popular services, with standard connectors in all plans and premium connectors in select plans, and custom connectors reach any public API. They can be used as tools, as actions in agent flows, and as knowledge sources.
Availability	**Generally Available** Using connectors as knowledge sources is labeled preview in Microsoft Learn.
License / access	Standard connectors come with all Copilot Studio plans. Premium connectors are available in select plans.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Connecting an agent or flow to SharePoint, Dynamics 365, Salesforce or your own API.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/advanced-connectors

Agent flows
Category: Business Workflow

Microsoft description	Automations you design in Copilot Studio with a trigger and at least one action. They are deterministic, so the same input gives the same output, and they can mix AI actions, human approval steps, built-in logic and connectors. Trigger them manually, on a schedule, or from other events or agents.
Availability	**Generally Available** Microsoft describes agent flows as the established format in the standard harness.
License / access	Flows consume Copilot Studio capacity for each action they run. Microsoft Learn describes this as part of the standard harness.
Best for (our interpretation)	*A predictable, repeatable business process such as an approval, a notification, or a document step that an agent can call.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/flows-overview **Blog:** https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/blog/copilot-studio/introducing-agent-flows-transforming-automation-with-ai-first-workflows/

Workflows in Copilot Studio
Category: Business Workflow

Microsoft description	The automation experience powered by the GitHub Copilot harness. You build on a redesigned visual canvas with native AI actions, agent handoffs and node-level testing, and workflows can be triggered manually, by events or agents, or on a schedule. Microsoft's blog says workflows are the new automation experience.
Availability	**Generally Available** Follows the GitHub Copilot harness, which became generally available August 3, 2026. Some related authoring experiences in the docs still carry preview labels.
License / access	Workflows consume Copilot Studio capacity for each action, and the GitHub Copilot harness uses Copilot Credits.
Best for (our interpretation)	*Business processes that combine fixed steps with AI reasoning, with a human review step where it matters.*
Learn more	**Learn:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/workflows-experience/flows-overview **Blog:** https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/blog/copilot-studio/new-and-improved-github-copilot-harness-agent-skills-and-richer-context/

Heads up: Copilot connectors (Shared Capability) bring content into Copilot. Connectors in Copilot Studio (this section) let an agent or flow reach and act on other systems. Different tools with similar names.

5 Emerging & Frontier

A short look at where Microsoft is heading next.

A short look at where Microsoft is heading. These items change often and many are not available to everyone yet. Treat this page as a preview, not a plan.

Capability	Status	What Microsoft says	Learn more
Frontier program	Frontier	Microsoft's opt-in early access to preview AI features before general availability. For work, you need a Microsoft Copilot license and your organization must opt in; Frontier features are labeled (Frontier).	**Support:** What is Frontier? **Learn:** Get started with Frontier (admin)
Preview and rolling-release capabilities	Varies	Copilot features roll out gradually to part of a tenant before reaching everyone, so the same feature can be visible to one colleague and not another. On the roadmap, status moves from In development to Rolling out to Launched.	**Learn:** Use the AI at Work Roadmap **Learn:** Copilot release notes
Home, with Office in Copilot	Frontier	A new starting point where Chat and Cowork come together, with Word, Excel and PowerPoint built in so files stay editable and shareable inside Copilot. Office editing began rolling out to Frontier customers on October 9, 2026.	**Blog:** Introducing the new Copilot **Blog:** Microsoft Copilot Blog archive
Code	Frontier	Describe an app, tracker, dashboard or automation in plain language and Copilot builds it, using the same underlying technology as GitHub Copilot in a sandbox. Copilot Managed Runtime, which hosts these solutions inside Microsoft 365, is in preview. Code uses usage-based billing.	**Blog:** Introducing the new Copilot **Learn:** USL and usage-based billing
Autopilot	Private preview	A persistent, proactive agent that keeps working when you are not. Previously called Scout. Uses usage-based billing.	**Blog:** Introducing the new Copilot
Skills, custom skills, and skills in Agent Builder	Preview (Frontier)	Custom skills are rolling into more places. In Agent Builder, adding skills is in preview and limited to organizations in the Frontier program. See the skills map earlier in this guide for what is available today.	**Learn:** Agent Builder overview
Plugins and the plugin registry	Rolling Out	A plugin packages skills, connectors, agents and MCP servers so they can be discovered, governed and shared. The registry began rolling out in late September 2026 and the Agents button becomes a Plugins button between late October and late November 2026.	**Learn:** What is a Copilot plugin? **Message Center:** MC1484008
Next wave of Copilot Notebooks	Frontier	Create a notebook by describing your goal, delegate simple work to Copilot, and edit Word, Excel and PowerPoint files without leaving Notebooks. Some pieces are coming to Frontier in the coming weeks.	**Blog:** What's New in Notebooks, October 2026
Apps in Copilot Studio	Preview	Makers can describe an app in natural language and refine it alongside agents and workflows.	**Learn:** Copilot Studio overview **Blog:** New in Copilot Studio, Sept 2026

Keep learning

Bookmark these Microsoft sources. Together they answer almost every “is it available yet?” question.

Microsoft Copilot Blog	Product announcements and monthly What’s New posts. Best for what just shipped. https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/category/microsoft-copilot/blog/microsoft-copilot-blog
Microsoft Learn: Microsoft Copilot	Product documentation, licensing, release notes and training modules. https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/
Microsoft Support: Copilot help and learning	Step-by-step how-tos, prompting guidance and app-by-app help for end users. https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/
Microsoft AI at Work Roadmap (formerly Microsoft 365 Roadmap)	Planned and rolling-out features with status and dates. Filter by product. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/roadmap
Microsoft 365 Copilot release notes	What reached general availability, by platform and date. https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/release-notes
Microsoft Copilot Studio documentation	For makers: agents, workflows, apps, licensing and governance. https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/
Agent Academy for Copilot Studio	Free, hands-on training for people who want to build. https://microsoft.github.io/agent-academy/
Microsoft Copilot pricing and plans	Current list pricing for business plans. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/pricing/business

How to check a capability yourself

1. Open the card’s Learn more link first. Microsoft Support and Learn pages carry the license and availability notes.
2. If a page is missing or thin, search Microsoft Learn and Microsoft Support directly for the product name.
3. Check the Microsoft Copilot Blog archive for the latest announcement and the monthly What’s New post.
4. Check the AI at Work Roadmap or the Copilot release notes for rollout status and dates.

Method: Descriptions are paraphrased from the linked Microsoft pages, with Microsoft Support first, then Microsoft Learn, product and licensing pages, and Microsoft Copilot Blog and Message Center notices where a feature is too new for formal documentation. Workshop and MAICON materials were used only for audience context, never for product definitions.